

Talk 2: When Kids Hear Things From Friends

Ages 6–8

Introduction

Hi, and welcome to Bright Talks.

As parents, many of us want our children to grow up feeling confident, safe, and comfortable coming to us with their questions. But as children grow, something important begins to change:

We're no longer the only voices they hear.

Friends, classmates, older siblings, media, and conversations at school begin introducing new words, ideas, and questions—sometimes long before we expected them.

And eventually, your child may come home and say something that completely catches you off guard.

When that happens, your first instinct might be:

"Where did you hear THAT?"

Take a breath.

Because that unexpected question may actually be an invitation.

Today, we're going to talk about how to respond with curiosity instead of panic so your child continues seeing you as a safe and trusted source.

When Other Voices Enter the Conversation

At six, seven, and eight, friendships become increasingly important.

Children talk.

They compare experiences.

They repeat things they've heard from siblings, adults, television, online content, or other kids and they don't always understand what those things actually mean.

So when your child brings home a new word or idea, remember:

Hearing something isn't the same as understanding it.

Before correcting them or jumping into an explanation, find out what they actually know.

You might ask:

"What do you think that means?"

"Where did you hear that?"

or simply,

"Tell me more about that."

Their answer may surprise you.

Sometimes the conversation you were preparing yourself to have isn't the conversation your child needs at all.

Respond to Curiosity With Curiosity

Remember what we talked about in our last lesson:

Respond to curiosity with curiosity.

If your child asks an uncomfortable question, try not to let your facial expression answer before your words do.

Pause.

Listen.

Stay curious.

You don't have to immediately correct every word or explain everything they might eventually need to know.

First, understand what they're asking.

Then give a truthful, simple, age appropriate response. And pause again.

Let your child's curiosity, not your anxiety help determine where the conversation goes next.

When a Friend Shares Something Inappropriate

Sometimes what your child hears may be inaccurate, inappropriate, or simply more mature than they're ready to understand.

Those moments can feel unsettling.

But they also give you an opportunity to reinforce an important message:

"I'm really glad you told me."

You can explain that sometimes kids hear or repeat things they don't fully understand, and your child never has to feel embarrassed about coming to you.

If what they heard isn't accurate, gently give them the truth.

If it's something they're not ready to understand fully, you can say:

"There's more to that, and we'll keep talking about it as you get older. For now, here's what I want you to know."

You're not avoiding the conversation.

You're meeting your child where they are.

Helping Them Navigate Their Friendships

We also don't want children to believe that a friend is automatically "bad" because they said something inappropriate.

That child may simply be repeating something they heard somewhere else.

Instead, help your child learn what they can do when a conversation makes them uncomfortable.

They can change the subject.

They can walk away.

They can say, *"I don't want to talk about that."*

And they can always come tell you.

This gives children permission to have boundaries with their peers without teaching them to fear their friends.

A Christian Perspective

As Christian parents, we want our children to learn how to recognize truth while also treating other people with grace.

Not everything they hear will reflect your family's beliefs or God's design for bodies, relationships, and sexuality.

That's why our goal isn't to shelter children from every different idea.

It's to give them a strong foundation so they know where to bring those ideas when they encounter them.

We can help our children seek what is true while responding to others with kindness, wisdom, and compassion.

Key Takeaway

When your child comes home with a surprising question, remember:

Pause. Get curious. Clarify. Connect.

You don't have to panic.

You don't have to know exactly what to say.

And you don't have to turn every question into a thirty-minute lesson.

Sometimes the most important thing you can say is simply:

"I'm glad you came to me."

Because every time your child brings something confusing to you and is met with calmness, honesty, and love, they're learning:

"I can bring the hard things here."

Wrapping Up

As we finish today's lesson, remember that you won't always be able to control what your child hears.

But you can influence where they go to make sense of it.

Stay curious.

Listen before you react.

Answer honestly.

And keep reminding your child that there is no question too awkward, confusing, or embarrassing to bring home.

As their curiosity continues to grow, some of those questions will naturally become bigger and more specific.

In our next talk, Questions About Babies, Sex & Where We Come From, we'll help you navigate those moments with honest, age appropriate answers without giving your child more information than they're ready for.

And we'll introduce a simple approach you can use when those bigger questions arrive:

Answer. Pause. Listen.

We'll see you in the next lesson.